

values of the Enlightenment, but also as the most famous citizen of my adopted City of Brotherly Love.

Franklin's extraordinary accomplishments as Founding Father, framer, statesman, diplomat, scientist, philosopher, author, master of the epigram, and fount of earthy wisdom are widely known and justly celebrated. But his astounding entrepreneurship—remarkable for *any* era—offers the greatest contrast in some ways with our own age.

In today's grandiose era of capitalism, the word *entrepreneur* has come to be commonly associated with those who are motivated to create new enterprises largely by the desire for personal wealth or even greed. But in fact *entrepreneur* simply means “one who undertakes an enterprise,” a person who founds and directs an organization. At its best, entrepreneurship entails something far more important than mere money.

Please do not take my word for it. Again heed the words of the great Joseph Schumpeter. In his *Theory of Economic Development*, written nearly a century ago, Schumpeter dismissed material and monetary gain as the prime mover of the entrepreneur, finding motivations like these to be far more powerful:

(1) The joy of creating, of getting things done, of simply exercising one's energy and ingenuity, and (2) The will to conquer: the impulse to fight, . . . to succeed for the sake, not of the fruits of success, but of success itself.

Entrepreneurs and Capitalists

There is a difference, then, between entrepreneurs and capitalists. As Franklin biographer H. W. Brands put it, “Had Franklin possessed the soul of a true capitalist, he would have devoted the time he saved from printing to making money somewhere else.” But he did not. For Franklin, the getting of money was always a means to an end, not an end in itself. The other enterprises he created, as well as his inventions, were designed for the public weal, not for his personal